

Tourism in Puducherry



One of the most unique characteristics of the Union Territory of Puducherry, and the main reason why thousands of tourists flock to it every year, is that it is a "melting-pot" of varied cultures. And helping Puducherry achieve this distinction are its history, geography, spirituality, and of course, the gifts of good old mother nature!

A key component of Puducherry's history is its "French connection"!

The French were ruling

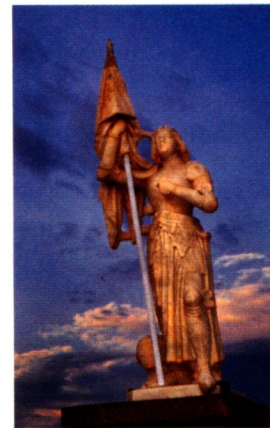
Puducherry, the capital of the Union Territory, between 1670 and 1954. The nearly 300-year old French legacy has been very well-preserved by the Puducherry government, and is hence still visible in the Puducherry town of today. Tiny streets running across the city in a grid-like pattern stand testimony to the genius of the French engineers, classic 18th century French mansions adorn many a side-walk, and many streets continue to have French names.

While Puducherry's history is responsible for its international influences, its geography, comprising of four regions spanning three Indian states (Tamil Nadu, Kerala, and Andhra Pradesh), adds to its multi-culturalism.

Its historical and geographical contexts

Angels, and the Kuthba mosque, all of which go a long way in fostering a sense of oneness in the secular and peace-loving people of the city.

For the "spiritually-uninclined" too, Puducherry has a lot of surprises in store! Where there are beaches, there can be no dearth of fun, and the Chunnambar beach resort assures you of a day's worth of fun and frolic! This resort on Cuddalore road boasts of a floating restaurant, and a school of row-boats, speed boats and pedal boats that you can take out on a joyful boat ride in the beautiful backwaters. Avid bird watchers can head for the Ousteri lake, and true-blue beach buffs can chill out at the Ruby Beach in Veerampattinam. In addition to this, the Department of Tourism

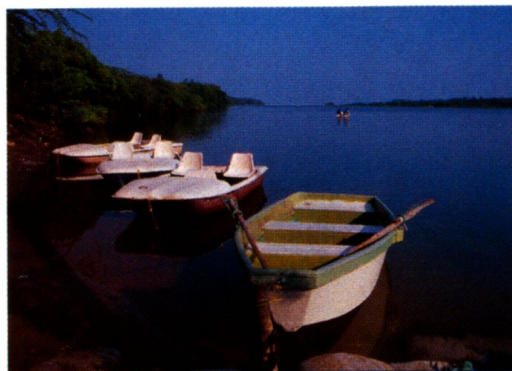


too is constantly endeavouring to enhance the holiday experience of its tourists. For instance, the department is planning to setup a water sports complex at Muruganpakkam. Besides, hoteliers in and around Puducherry have also been instructed to offer "tourist-friendly" packages at reasonable rates.

In addition to being home to many tourist attractions, Puducherry also



aside, Puducherry is fast becoming a "spiritually-charged" city, with serene beaches that can calm your frazzled nerves, a generally tranquil atmosphere, and not-to-mention, the immensely popular Sri Aurobindo Ashram, which imparts peace and spiritual guidance to people from different parts of the world. Besides the Ashram, the city plays host to the famous Manakkula Vinayagar temple, the sea-facing Church of Our Lady of the



serves as a 'tourist hub', since sought-after pilgrim destinations such as Karaikkal, Chidambaram, etc., can be easily accessed from the city.

So, if you're looking for an ideal weekend getaway that can make all your senses happy, then simply drive down to Puducherry.....good times are not too far away!